

Do the stances of Christian churches influence identifiers' political beliefs?

Caroline Kajkowski

April 1, 2026

1 Original Study

The study I chose to replicate for this project: “The Influence of Religious–Political Sophistication on U.S. Public Opinion” by Eric Schmidt (2017). The main purpose of this study is to discover whether and how religious institutes’ viewpoints affect parishioners’ understanding and reasoning on political issues. This phenomenon is referred to as Religious–Political Sophistication (RPS). Other literature on this topic, discuss the direct influence of religious leaders and how these teachings potentially influence religious identifiers’ political beliefs/alignment. Schmidt suggests on top of direct influence, religious identifiers also take in account their church’s stance on issues (i.e. the Roman Catholic Church’s stance on abortion). Therefore, the author is looking to test three hypotheses regarding RPS:

- Religious identifiers who know their church’s teachings are more likely to share these views
- RPS has a greater impact on their public opinion in comparison to secular knowledge
- RPS helps connect religious identifiers’ faith to politics

Method

To test the hypotheses above, the author took data from 2014 Cooperative Congressional Election Study (CCES) and an original CCES module. From there, he took the best represented religious traditions (Roman Catholic, Evangelical Protestants, and Mainline Protestants) to analyze their political positions on same sex marriage and abortion.

2 Data

```
1 #insert data
2 rep_data <- read.csv("/Users/carolinekajkowski/Desktop/Trinity/StatsII_2026/
  replication/my_answers/original_files/replication-data.csv")
3
4 #subsetting the data to exclude ambiguous answers
5 mainliners <- subset(rep_data, mainline == 1 & ambiguous == 0)
6 evan.cath <- subset(rep_data, mainline != 1 & ambiguous==0)
```

In the original R script, the author decides to separate the dataset to create two new datasets with all inputs of Roman Catholic and Evangelical Protestants in one and Mainline Protestants in another. The justification for this in the paper was that the author found that the Roman Catholic church and Evangelical Protestants have more clear conservative opinions on same-sex marriage and abortion rights, while Mainline Protestants have varying views on these social issues. Therefore, the study is focused on the effect of RPS on Roman Catholic and Evangelical Protestants while treating Mainline Protestants as a comparison for later on.

Input variables:

Party ID (0 = strong Democrat; 6 = strong Republican)

Church attendance (0 = never; 5 = more than once per week)

Biblical Literacy (the number of correct answers to three multiple-choice questions about the Bible's books and figures)

Secular Political Knowledge (a three-point scale indicating each respondent's number of correct responses to two questions about national politics)

RPS (1 = respondent knows official denomination stance; 0 = respondent doesn't know)

Controlled variables: age, ideology, gender, race, education, family income, and religious tradition (1 = Roman Catholic; 0 = Evangelical Protestant)

Outcome variable:

Support (1 = support rights (same-sex marriage or abortion); 0 = oppose)

3 Original Models

The author creates binomial logistic regression models that are used throughout the paper:

Secular Model:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Support} = & \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{Party Identification} + \beta_2 \text{Secular Political Knowledge} \\ & + \beta_3 (\text{Party Identification} \times \text{Secular Political Knowledge}) \end{aligned}$$

Naive Model:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Support} = & \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{ Party Identification} + \beta_2 \text{ Secular Political Knowledge} \\ & + \beta_3 (\text{Party Identification} \times \text{Secular Political Knowledge}) \\ & + \beta_4 \text{ Church Attendance} + \beta_5 \text{ Biblical Literacy} \\ & + \beta_6 (\text{Church Attendance} \times \text{Biblical Literacy})\end{aligned}$$

”Culture Wars” Model:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Support} = & \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{ Party Identification} + \beta_2 \text{ Secular Political Knowledge} \\ & + \beta_3 (\text{Party Identification} \times \text{Secular Political Knowledge}) \\ & + \beta_4 \text{ Church Attendance} + \beta_5 \text{ Biblical Literacy} \\ & + \beta_6 (\text{Church Attendance} \times \text{Biblical Literacy}) \\ & + \beta_7 (\text{Church Attendance} \times \text{Secular Political Knowledge})\end{aligned}$$

RPS Model:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Support} = & \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{ Party Identification} + \beta_2 \text{ Secular Political Knowledge} \\ & + \beta_3 (\text{Party Identification} \times \text{Secular Political Knowledge}) \\ & + \beta_4 \text{ Church Attendance} + \beta_5 \text{ Biblical Literacy} \\ & + \beta_6 (\text{Church Attendance} \times \text{Biblical Literacy}) \\ & + \beta_7 (\text{Church Attendance} \times \text{Secular Political Knowledge}) \\ & + \beta_8 \text{ RPS} \\ & + \beta_9 (\text{Church Attendance} \times \text{RPS})\end{aligned}$$

4 Replicated Tables

Tables 1 and 2 in this paper look at Evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics support of same-sex marriage and abortion rights (respectively) using all four models above. The author reports that the secular models conclude that the interaction term of party identification x secular political knowledge is not significant, therefore, justified RPS as an appropriate measurement for discussing political influence on religious identifiers. This is shown in the RPS models with the interaction term of RPS x church attendance being significant. This means that on average for a religious identifier who correctly knows their tradition’s stance, each additional unit of church attendance is associated with a decrease in the log-odds of supporting same-sex marriage by 0.605. Also that on average for a religious identifier who correctly knows their tradition’s view on abortion, each additional unit of church attendance is associated with a decrease in the log-odds of supporting abortion by 0.818. The difference between the different levels of church attendance frequency (0-5) is illustrated better later on in the report (Figures 1-4).

Table 1: Evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics' support of SSM Replication

	<i>Dependent variable:</i>			
	Secular	Naive	ssm Culture Wars	RPS
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
age	−0.025** (0.011)	−0.025** (0.013)	−0.025** (0.013)	−0.032** (0.015)
female	0.533* (0.323)	0.481 (0.351)	0.478 (0.352)	0.726* (0.400)
black	0.059 (0.493)	−0.138 (0.586)	−0.140 (0.586)	−0.331 (0.633)
education.collapsed	0.055 (0.126)	0.075 (0.144)	0.076 (0.144)	0.014 (0.165)
income.collapsed	0.013 (0.058)	0.037 (0.063)	0.038 (0.064)	0.048 (0.072)
ideology.collapsed	−0.830*** (0.250)	−0.793*** (0.281)	−0.795*** (0.281)	−0.922*** (0.313)
romancatholic	1.571*** (0.336)	1.303*** (0.366)	1.309*** (0.371)	1.111*** (0.409)
partyid	−0.249* (0.143)	−0.242 (0.163)	−0.245 (0.165)	−0.183 (0.197)
secular.knowledge	−0.082 (0.308)	−0.141 (0.354)	−0.108 (0.471)	0.040 (0.519)
church		−0.080 (0.263)	−0.061 (0.322)	0.044 (0.378)
bible.collapsed		−0.262 (0.512)	−0.261 (0.511)	−0.084 (0.550)
rps.ssm				−0.596 (0.764)
partyid:secular.knowledge	−0.002 (0.088)	0.002 (0.098)	0.004 (0.099)	−0.078 (0.116)
church:bible.collapsed		−0.074 (0.171)	−0.074 (0.170)	−0.054 (0.185)
secular.knowledge:church			−0.014 (0.138)	0.075 (0.159)
church:rps.ssm				−0.605** (0.262)
Constant	1.848** (0.834)	2.848** (1.148)	2.800** (1.236)	3.446** (1.384)
Observations	280	246	246	246
Log Likelihood	−139.734	−118.555	−118.549	−97.484
Akaike Inf. Crit.	301.468	265.110	267.099	228.969

Note:

*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Table 2: Evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics' support of abortion Replication

	<i>Dependent variable:</i>			
	Secular	Naive	abortion Culture Wars	RPS
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
age	−0.012 (0.011)	−0.019 (0.013)	−0.019 (0.013)	−0.015 (0.015)
female	0.419 (0.326)	0.298 (0.363)	0.297 (0.364)	0.320 (0.397)
black	0.411 (0.505)	−0.085 (0.629)	−0.087 (0.631)	−0.716 (0.674)
education.collapsed	−0.069 (0.128)	−0.042 (0.150)	−0.042 (0.151)	0.009 (0.173)
income.collapsed	0.077 (0.059)	0.036 (0.065)	0.036 (0.065)	0.046 (0.072)
ideology.collapsed	−1.120*** (0.255)	−1.320*** (0.310)	−1.320*** (0.310)	−1.498*** (0.330)
romancatholic	0.921*** (0.328)	0.775** (0.371)	0.776** (0.377)	0.515 (0.422)
partyid	−0.171 (0.140)	−0.150 (0.163)	−0.151 (0.168)	−0.039 (0.182)
secular.knowledge	−0.124 (0.314)	−0.250 (0.366)	−0.242 (0.473)	−0.124 (0.503)
church		0.565** (0.271)	0.569* (0.326)	0.823** (0.359)
bible.collapsed		1.105** (0.511)	1.104** (0.512)	0.928* (0.535)
rps.abortion				0.645 (0.808)
partyid:secular.knowledge	−0.059 (0.088)	−0.056 (0.100)	−0.055 (0.102)	−0.132 (0.109)
church:bible.collapsed		−0.530*** (0.179)	−0.530*** (0.179)	−0.385** (0.195)
secular.knowledge:church			−0.004 (0.142)	0.021 (0.159)
church:rps.abortion				−0.818*** (0.275)
Constant	1.898** (0.839)	2.085* (1.095)	2.074* (1.174)	1.768 (1.258)
Observations	279	245	245	245
Log Likelihood	−138.275	−112.479	−112.478	−100.031
Akaike Inf. Crit.	298.551	252.957	254.957	234.063

Note:

*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Table 3 takes a different approach and looks at whether the respondent's stance on same sex marriage predicts their stance on abortion and vice versa. In the code below, the models now include to RPS for the other outcome to see if they statistically impact each other. The table reports that the opposite RPS has no significance on the support of same-sex marriage or abortion. Therefore, the author concludes that RPS does not promote cross-issue constraint for Evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics.

```

1 model1 = glm(ssm ~ age + female + black + education.collapsed
2             + income.collapsed + ideology.collapsed + romancatholic
3             + partyid + secular.knowledge + partyid*secular.knowledge
4             + church + bible.collapsed + church*bible.collapsed
5             + church*secular.knowledge + rps.abortion
6             + church*rps.abortion, data=evan.cath, family="binomial")
7 summary(model1)
8
9 model2 = glm(abortion ~ age + female + black + education.collapsed
10            + income.collapsed + ideology.collapsed + romancatholic
11            + partyid + secular.knowledge + partyid*secular.knowledge
12            + church + bible.collapsed + church*bible.collapsed
13            + church*secular.knowledge + rps.ssm
14            + church*rps.ssm, data=evan.cath, family="binomial")
15 summary(model2)

```

Table 3: RPS does not promote cross-over issue constraint for Evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics

	SSM Support (1)	Abortion Support (2)
age	−0.023* (0.013)	−0.019 (0.013)
female	0.549 (0.370)	0.319 (0.371)
black	−0.537 (0.605)	−0.150 (0.629)
education.collapsed	0.125 (0.155)	−0.067 (0.155)
income.collapsed	0.041 (0.067)	0.036 (0.067)
ideology.collapsed	−0.868*** (0.290)	−1.361*** (0.315)
romancatholic	1.128*** (0.390)	0.657* (0.385)
partyid	−0.179 (0.169)	−0.127 (0.174)
secular.knowledge	−0.036 (0.493)	−0.252 (0.477)
church	0.013 (0.336)	0.661* (0.349)
bible.collapsed	−0.411 (0.526)	1.095** (0.517)
rps.abortion	0.003 (0.758)	
rps.ssm		0.162 (0.732)
partyid:secular.knowledge	−0.037 (0.102)	−0.069 (0.105)
church:bible.collapsed	0.039 (0.182)	−0.493*** (0.179)
secular.knowledge:church	0.014 (0.145)	0.020 (0.146)
church:rps.abortion	−0.411 (0.251)	
church:rps.ssm		−0.324 (0.241)
Constant	2.746** (1.272)	2.090* (1.202)
Observations	246	245
Log Likelihood	−112.603	−109.516
Akaike Inf. Crit.	259.206	253.033
Note:	7 *p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01	

Tables 4 and 5 look at the Mainline Protestants's support for same-sex marriage and abortion, however, the author choose to exclude the demographic variables from these models. As mentioned before, the author believed that Mainline protestants have more mixed views on this topics in comparison to Roman Catholics and Evangelical Protestants. Therefore, the main purpose of these models are to see if the RPS x church interaction are significant for the Mainline Protestants as well. In both tables they show that this term is indeed not significant. Therefore, the author concludes that RPS significantly predicts the attitudes of Evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics but because Mainline Protestants's teachings are less clear RPS does not significantly predict their attitudes on same-sex marriage and abortion.

Table 4: Mainline Protestants' support of SSM Replication

	<i>Dependent variable:</i>			
	Secular	Naive	ssm Culture Wars	RPS
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
partyid	-0.182 (0.165)	-0.095 (0.178)	-0.080 (0.181)	-0.064 (0.188)
secular.knowledge	0.911* (0.499)	0.924* (0.508)	0.646 (0.696)	0.579 (0.718)
church		-0.365 (0.439)	-0.436 (0.459)	-0.455 (0.482)
bible.collapsed		-0.130 (0.652)	0.010 (0.703)	-0.113 (0.716)
rps.ssm				0.633 (1.063)
partyid:secular.knowledge	-0.176 (0.120)	-0.229* (0.127)	-0.236* (0.128)	-0.241* (0.130)
church:bible.collapsed		0.140 (0.275)	0.083 (0.294)	0.108 (0.301)
secular.knowledge:church			0.131 (0.226)	0.120 (0.238)
church:rps.ssm				0.058 (0.416)
Constant	0.509 (0.624)	0.905 (1.103)	1.000 (1.125)	0.715 (1.153)
Observations	91	82	82	82
Log Likelihood	-52.919	-47.535	-47.366	-46.415
Akaike Inf. Crit.	113.837	109.070	110.731	112.829

Note:

*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Table 5: Mainline Protestants' support of Abortion Replication

	<i>Dependent variable:</i>			
	Secular	Naive	abortion Culture Wars	RPS
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
partyid	-0.309* (0.174)	-0.290 (0.191)	-0.233 (0.200)	-0.173 (0.211)
secular.knowledge	0.557 (0.537)	0.503 (0.559)	-0.754 (0.801)	-1.087 (0.894)
church		-0.214 (0.438)	-0.607 (0.492)	-0.623 (0.594)
bible.collapsed		0.025 (0.679)	0.814 (0.842)	1.080 (0.941)
rps.abortion				0.997 (1.251)
partyid:secular.knowledge	-0.123 (0.125)	-0.153 (0.134)	-0.221 (0.146)	-0.254 (0.161)
church:bible.collapsed		0.169 (0.281)	-0.106 (0.325)	-0.201 (0.361)
secular.knowledge:church			0.632** (0.262)	0.783** (0.305)
church:rps.abortion				0.308 (0.541)
Constant	1.338* (0.697)	1.329 (1.164)	1.868 (1.284)	1.170 (1.477)
Observations	93	84	84	84
Log Likelihood	-51.172	-44.908	-41.624	-37.971
Akaike Inf. Crit.	110.345	103.817	99.248	95.942

Note:

*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Tables 6 and 7 pool all Evangelical Protestants, Roman Catholics, and Mainline Protestants together to look at their personal beliefs on whether their church opposes or supports different levels of same-sex marriage and abortion rights. This is used to understand if there are any projections of the respondent's own beliefs onto the religious tradition's actual stance.

```

1 #Data manipulation for 6&7
2 #
3 # Reports of Church teaching (ssm)
4 unique(rep_data$church.ssm)
5 rep_data$church.ssm <- as.character(rep_data$church.ssm)
6 str(rep_data$church.ssm)
7 church.reports.ssm <- recode(rep_data$church.ssm,
8                             "Not Available" = NA_character_)
9 table(church.reports.ssm)
10
11 # Reports of Church Teaching (Abortion)
12 # Take the 'Not Available' out

```

```

13 unique(rep_data$church.abortion)
14 table(rep_data$church.abortion)
15 str(rep_data$church.abortion)
16 church.reports.abortion <- recode(rep_data$church.abortion,
17                                "Not Available" = NA_character_)
18 table(church.reports.abortion)
19 #
20 #TABLE 6: RPS answer (SSM) and support/opposition to SSM
21 #
22 table6 <- prop.table(table(church.reports.ssm[rep_data$ambiguous==0],
23                             rep_data$ssm[rep_data$ambiguous==0]), 2)
24 round(table6, digits = 2)
25 table6_counts <- table(church.reports.ssm[rep_data$ambiguous==0], rep_
26                        data$ssm[rep_data$ambiguous==0])
27 sum(table6_counts[, 1])
28 sum(table6_counts[, 2])
29 #
30 #TABLE 7: RPS answer (abortion) and support/opposition
31 #
32 table7 <- prop.table(table(church.reports.abortion[rep_data$ambiguous
33                             ==0], rep_data$abortion[rep_data$ambiguous==0]), 2)
34 round(table7, digits = 2)
35 table7_counts <- table(church.reports.abortion[rep_data$ambiguous==0],
36                        rep_data$abortion[rep_data$ambiguous==0])
37 sum(table7_counts[, 1])
38 sum(table7_counts[, 2])

```

Table 6: Beliefs about church teaching on same-sex marriage by personal opinion on same-sex marriage Replication

	Opposes	Supports
Church supports SSM	0.04	0.50
Church supports civil unions	0.25	0.15
Church opposes SSM	0.62	0.15
Doesn't know	0.10	0.20
Total	1.00	1.00
n	199	201

Table 7: Beliefs about church teaching on abortion by personal opinion on unrestricted abortion rights Replication

	Opposes	Supports
Always Permit	0.01	0.34
DK	0.06	0.16
Establish Need	0.08	0.14
Never Permit	0.39	0.17
Standard GOP Exceptions	0.45	0.19
Total	1	1
n	200	200

Table 8 shows the Evangelical Protestant and Roman Catholic identifiers who misunderstand their church’s teachings and how that affects their view of same-sex marriage and abortion rights. For this the author created a new dummy variable that tested whether the respondent thinks their church is more liberal or not (1 = more liberal; 0 = correct or does not know). The main finding was that people who misunderstands their church’s teachings for being more liberal and attend church more, they are more likely to support same-sex marriage and abortion rights.

```

1      title = "Beliefs about church teaching on same-sex marriage by
2      personal opinion on same-sex marriage Replication",
3      digits = 2)
4  stargazer(table7_df,
5            type = "latex",
6            summary = FALSE,
7            rownames = TRUE,
8            title = "Beliefs about church teaching on abortion by personal
9            opinion on unrestricted abortion rights Replication",
10           digits = 2)
11 #
12 #TABLE 8: RPS Models (Incorrect RPS) (Evangelical Protestants and Roman
13 #Catholics)
14 inc.ssm <- glm(ssm ~ age + female + black + education.collapsed
15               + income.collapsed + ideology.collapsed + romancatholic
16               + partyid + secular.knowledge + partyid*secular.knowledge
17               + church + bible.collapsed + church*bible.collapsed
18               + church*secular.knowledge + incorrect.rps.ssm
19               + church*incorrect.rps.ssm, data=evan.cath, family="
20 binomial")
summary(inc.ssm)

```

Table 8: Incorrect RPS reports only influence political attitudes through church attendance: support for same-sex marriage and unrestricted abortion rights, evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics Replication

	<i>Dependent variable:</i>	
	ssm	abortion
	SSM Support	Abortion Support
	(1)	(2)
age	−0.029** (0.014)	−0.014 (0.014)
female	0.686* (0.378)	0.390 (0.386)
black	−0.287 (0.614)	−0.705 (0.678)
education.collapsed	0.048 (0.155)	0.008 (0.168)
income.collapsed	0.049 (0.068)	0.050 (0.069)
ideology.collapsed	−0.917*** (0.304)	−1.397*** (0.324)
romancatholic	1.127*** (0.393)	0.493 (0.423)
partyid	−0.236 (0.181)	−0.127 (0.180)
secular.knowledge	−0.095 (0.500)	−0.202 (0.489)
church	−0.096 (0.338)	0.309 (0.361)
bible.collapsed	−0.123 (0.527)	1.028* (0.530)
incorrect.rps.ssm	0.275 (0.750)	
incorrect.rps.abortion		−0.734 (0.828)
partyid:secular.knowledge	−0.012 (0.108)	−0.088 (0.108)
church:bible.collapsed	−0.148 (0.178)	−0.472** (0.189)
secular.knowledge:church	−0.033 (0.148)	−0.039 (0.156)
church:incorrect.rps.ssm	0.492* (0.251)	
church:incorrect.rps.abortion		0.790*** (0.287)
Constant	2.831** (1.343)	2.192 (1.342)
Observations	246	245
Log Likelihood	−106.152	−102.855
Akaike Inf. Crit.	1246.303	239.709
<i>Note:</i> *p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01		

5 Replicated Figures

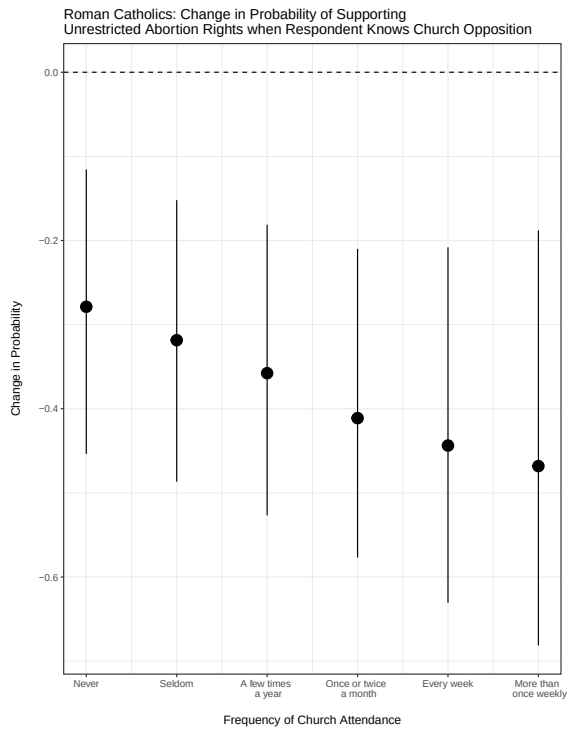
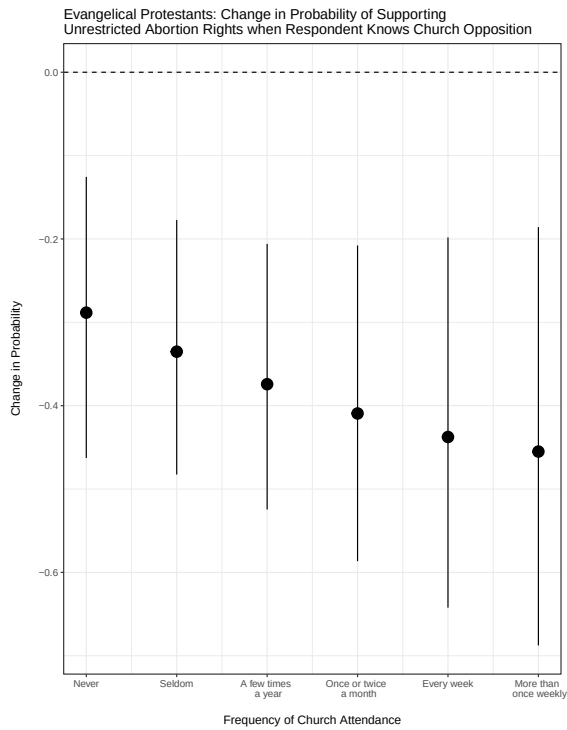
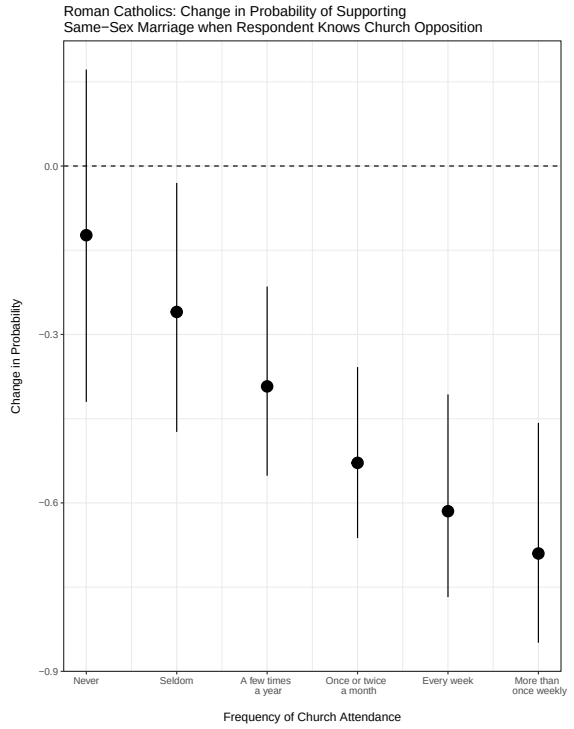
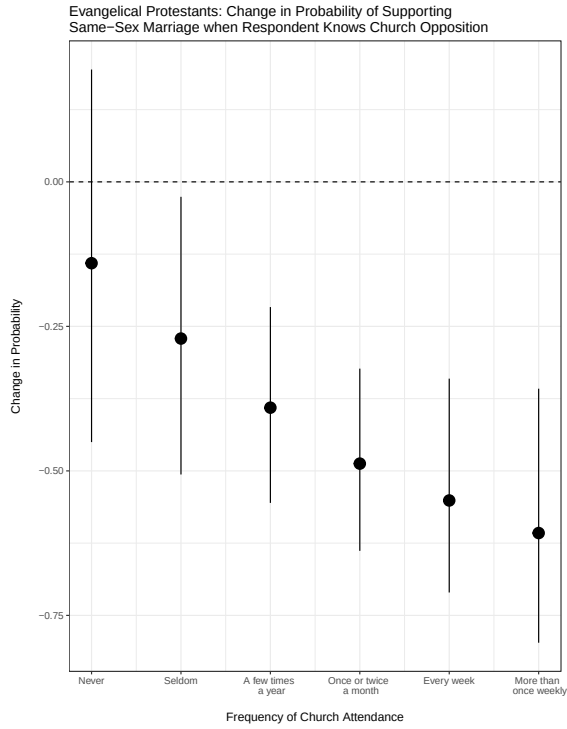
For the figures in the paper, the code below uses an old package "Zelig" that is not available with the newest version of R studio. Therefore, I had to download it from the CRAN archive. The main goal with this code is to run a regression and be able to simulate the first difference of each scenerio.

```
1 # Run the RPS model
2 mylogit = Zelig::zelig(data=evan.cath, ssm ~ age + female + black +
   education.collapsed
3                       + income.collapsed + ideology.collapsed
4                       + romancatholic + partyid + secular.knowledge
5                       + interaction1 + church + bible.collapsed + interaction2
6                       + interaction3 + rps.ssm + interaction4, model = "logit")
7 summary(mylogit)
8
9 x.out = setx(mylogit)
10 z.out = sim(mylogit, x = x.out)
```

The figures consist of three points: lower bound, upper bound, and the partial effect of increasing church attendance on supporting same-sex marriage and abortion rights for Evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics.

```
1 # Simulate first difference
2 s.out = sim(z.out, x = x.low, x1 = x.high)
3 summary(s.out)
4 LB.2 = -0.5062194
5 UB.2 = -0.02585697
6 PE.2 = -0.2710665
```

In the graphs below, it consistantly shows that when a respondant knows their church's stance the prodicted probabilty of RPS decreases when Therefore, those who attend church less, tend to align more with the church's stance on same-sex marriage or abortion.



6 My Extension

For the extension of this project, I decided to examine the "Culture Wars" model and remove the interaction term between secular knowledge and church attendance to test if this term has a meaningful contribution to the model's fit. In the original model, this interaction captures whether the effect of secular political knowledge on policy attitudes is conditioned by church attendance and is the main mechanism for the model. I choose to do this because in almost every (except Mainline Protestant's support of abortion rights) this term is not statistically significant to the model. By removing it, I am testing whether there is statistical evidence for the interaction effect in the model. Specifically, I examined the three logistic regressions where the interaction was not significant (four "Culture Wars" model total), excluded the interaction term, then compared the reduced and full model using a Likelihood Ratio Test.

- Null hypothesis (H_0): The interaction between church attendance and secular political knowledge has no effect on policy support.

$$H_0 : \beta_{\text{church} \times \text{secular_knowledge}} = 0$$

- Alternative hypothesis (H_1): The interaction between church attendance and secular political knowledge significantly affects policy support.

$$H_1 : \beta_{\text{church} \times \text{secular_knowledge}} \neq 0$$

```
1 summary(inc.abortion)
2
3 stargazer(
4   inc.ssm, inc.abortion,
5   type = "latex",
6   title = "Incorrect RPS reports only influence political attitudes
7           through church attendance: support for same-sex marriage and
8           unrestricted abortion rights, evangelical Protestants and Roman
9           Catholics Replication",
10  column.labels = c("SSM Support", "Abortion Support"),
11  font.size = "scriptsize" )
12 #
13 #EXTENSION
14 #
15
16 #Evangelical and Roman Catholics: SSM
17 cw1 <- glm(ssm ~ age + female + black + education.collapsed
```

Table 9: Likelihood Ratio Test: Evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics' support of SSM

	Resid. Df	Resid. Dev	Df	Deviance	Pr(>Chi)
1	232	237.110			
2	231	237.099	1	0.011	0.918

Table 10: Likelihood Ratio Test: Evangelical Protestants and Roman Catholics' support of Abortion

	Resid. Df	Resid. Dev	Df	Deviance	Pr(>Chi)
1	231	224.957			
2	230	224.957	1	0.001	0.980

Table 11: Likelihood Ratio Test: Mainline Protestants' support of Abortion

	Resid. Df	Resid. Dev	Df	Deviance	Pr(>Chi)
1	75	95.070			
2	74	94.731	1	0.339	0.561

Based on the p-values of 0.918, 0.98, and 0.561, we fail to reject the null hypothesis that the effect of secular knowledge on issue support does not vary by the frequency of church attendance. Therefore, the interaction term between secular knowledge and church attendance are not significant and is not necessary to be included in these "Culture Wars" models. This result suggests limited statistical evidence for the claim that frequency of church attendance effects the influence of secular knowledge, casting uncertainty for the validity of this mechanism in the model.

References

Schmidt, Eric R. (2017). “The Influence of Religious–Political Sophistication on U.S. Public Opinion.” *Political Behavior*, 40(1), 21–53. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11109-017-9390-z>